

Building Your Brand in the Digital Age



Understanding the Empowered Client

Great branding starts with knowing and understanding your ideal client. Today, clients are doing more online than ever before, from researching ideas to reading reviews and making purchasing decisions.

You can't afford to wait until a prospective client picks up the phone to teach them about your business. You need to build your brand online where they can find it at the beginning stages of research.



TODAY'S EMPOWERED CLIENTS ARE:

Online all day, every day. Whether they are queuing at the supermarket or in bed after the kids are asleep and everything else in between, they are using tools like the Houzz app for new ideas and inspiration. Mobile devices are everywhere, and your clients are on them 24/7.

Well-informed. Today's clients spend time researching online about whatever purchase or hiring decision they're making well before they make their purchase, whether it's comparing products or reading reviews.

Participatory. Few clients are ready to hand over a cheque and say "I'll see you in 6 months". They want to feel part of the process and able to make intelligent, empowered, personalised decisions.

85x

Number of times people check their mobile phones each day on average

87%

Percentage of people who say their smartphone never leaves their side, day or night

41%

Percentage of Millennials who researched their last purchase on a smartphone

Storytelling

Building your brand online can be intimidating. Questions like “How do I stand out? Where do I even start?” are common concerns. But don’t worry! Your knowledge about your own business is the perfect place to start.

What do you say when clients ask, “Why should I hire you over another professional?” Put that answer into writing and display it proudly on your website and profile. Don’t wait for people to pick up the phone to answer their questions. Telling your story and defining your business is a powerful way to set you apart from the competition.

Studies show people buy emotionally, and justify the choice rationally. Savvy businesses give people both: providing facts and making a personal connection online.



DID YOU KNOW?

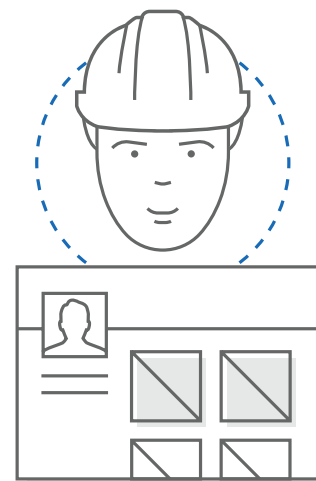
Storytelling can take many forms online, whether it’s a written profile description, a video explanation of who you are, or educational content aimed to help potential clients understand your expertise.

Show Your Passion & Expertise

Your website or Houzz profile description are often the first things homeowners see when they begin researching professionals. Give them a good first impression by telling your story and sharing your expertise and passion for the job.

What do you specialise in? How long have you been building or decorating homes? What kind of experience and passion will you bring to the project? Homeowners aren't just looking for someone to do the job; they're looking for a partner they believe in to embark on this journey with.

Jeff King of Jeff King & Company tells homeowners about the level of service they offer to their clients.



"Jeff King & Company provides award-winning green building and remodeling services. We combine painstaking craftsmanship, aesthetic understanding and sustainable building practices to create healthy, efficient and beautiful homes. Our 17 years of successful practice comes from dedication to building long-term relationships with our clients and team collaborators—and that's why the majority of our work comes directly from referrals. In fact, we set out to make every client a client for life."



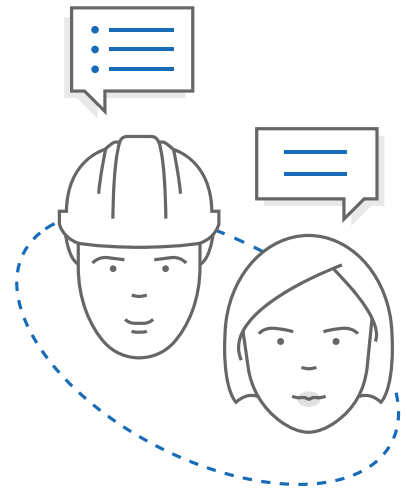
Jeff King & Company

Appeal to Their Emotions

Tugging on a potential client's heartstrings can create a connection that speaks to their emotional needs. Whenever you describe yourself and your work, whether it's on your website or your Houzz profile, sharing your passion for your job will help you stand out.

You're speaking to clients who are just as excited as you are about collaborating on future projects and building lifelong relationships. Helping a potential client understand your approach to each project can make the difference between getting the project or losing out on a job.

This quote from Rhonda Kieson Designs shows her passion and appeals to clients' emotions about their home's potential.



"A room should be like a good friend. It should be compelling enough to draw you in, strong enough to lend you strength, warm enough to comfort you, and familiar enough to embrace your soul."

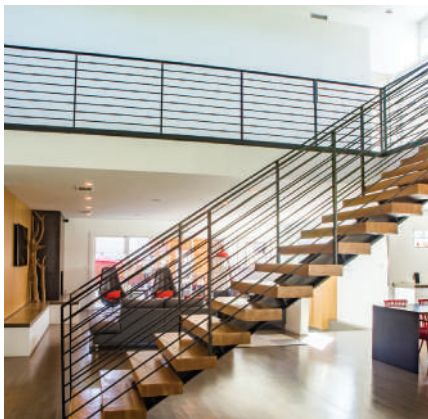
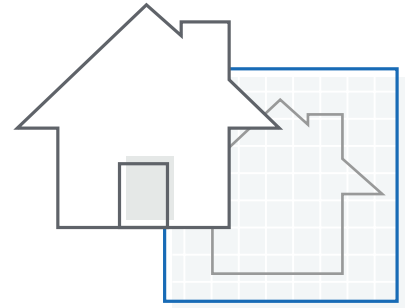


Rhonda Kieson Designs

Post Photos for the Clients You Want

The type of photos you add to your profile will determine the kinds of clients that you attract. If all of your images feature one type of project, homeowners will assume you specialise in that style. Just as important, it will set your client's expectations. If you know how to leverage your photography, you can use this to your advantage.

For a long time, Wiley Gilliam from Modern Craft Construction wanted to focus his work on more modern homes, but was attracting clients who wanted a variety of styles. In an effort to target the projects he wanted, he started to only post photos of his modern design projects on Houzz and renamed his company "Modern Craft". Since then, Wiley has become a leader in modern home design in his city.



Modern Craft Construction



Enhance Your Business

With Houzz Pro, you now have access to profile analytics, a unique CRM communication tool to keep track of projects and messages, subscription management details, and new place to find all your Pro resources.

If you'd like assistance with the new Houzz Pro Portal or are looking simplify your business management processes, Houzz can help.

Get in touch with the Houzz Team at **ukprocommunity@houzz.com** for more information on our comprehensive business growth and management system.